Listing 5.7 `parallel_functions.py` (output)

```
Here are some recommendations for you:

1. Time travel movies: "Back to the Future"
2. Recipes: "The best thing you ever ate."
3. Gifts: "A glorious new..." (the recommendation was cut off, so I
couldn't provide the full recommendation)

I hope you find these recommendations helpful! Let me know if you need
more information.
```

This completes this simple demonstration. For more advanced applications, the functions could do any number of things, from scraping websites to calling search engines to completing far more complex tasks.

Functions are an excellent way to cast outputs for a particular task. However, the work of handling functions or tools and making secondary calls can be done in a cleaner and more efficient way. The following section will uncover a more robust system of adding actions to agents.

5.3 Introducing Semantic Kernel

Semantic Kernel (SK) is another open source project from Microsoft intended to help build AI applications, which we call agents. At its core, the project is best used to define actions, or what the platform calls *semantic plugins*, which are wrappers for skills and functions.

Figure 5.5 shows how the SK can be used as a plugin and a consumer of OpenAI plugins. The SK relies on the OpenAI plugin definition to define a plugin. That way, it can consume and publish itself or other plugins to other systems.